

Edmontosaurus

ed-MONT-oh-SORE-us



- **When** 75–65 million years ago (Late Cretaceous)
- **Fossil location** USA, Canada
- **Habitat** Swamps of N. America
- **Length** 43 ft (13 m) long
- **Diet** Plants

Edmontosaurus is named after Edmonton town in Alberta, Canada, where the first fossils were found in 1917. One of the largest hadrosaurids, it weighed up to 4½ tons (4 metric tons). Hollow areas around its nostrils may have contained inflatable sacs that *Edmontosaurus* could expand like balloons and perhaps use to make sounds.

▲ **MOUTH** *Edmontosaurus* had a broad beak for cropping leaves. The back of its mouth was packed with hundreds of tiny teeth for chewing. The teeth were continually replaced, with new ones taking perhaps a year to form.

► **STANDING TALL** *Edmontosaurus* walked on four feet and could bend low to reach plants on the ground. It could also rear up on its hind legs to reach higher branches, but it couldn't run on its hind legs.

Mummified *Edmontosaurus*

Preserved skin

Dinosaur “mummies”

Some very well-preserved *Edmontosaurus* fossils have been found, including fossils of mummified bodies that show skin and other soft tissues. These animals seem to have died in a hot, dry location where the body dried out quickly after death, before soft tissues could decompose. At some later date, the mummies were buried in soft mud or sand, preserving an imprint of the skin.



▲ **SKIN IMPRESSION** Fossilized skin impressions reveal that *Edmontosaurus* had scaly skin with large bumps.

